revenue of Rs 500 crores is expected to materialize, accompanied by the creation of 5000 employment opportunities. Furthermore, this pioneering policy aims to train and certify 5000 drone pilots in Uttarakhand, empowering them to offer their expertise both domestically and internationally.

- To ensure the efficacy of the drone policy, a subsidy framework has been established to bolster industry establishment. Drone system design and manufacturing units will be given subsidies up to 75 percent of the lease rent in the first year or up to Rs 20 lakh, 50 percent or up to Rs 15 lakh in the second year, and 25 percent or up to Rs 10 lakh in the third year.
- Expanding the scope of the subsidy, businesses providing drone services will also enjoy incentives. This encompasses a maximum subsidy of Rs 10 lakhs in the initial year, Rs 7.5 lakhs in the second year, and a maximum of Rs 5 lakhs in the third year for industries engaged in drone services.
- The policy not only cultivates business but also nourishes startup growth within the drone technology sphere. Under the startup policy, 15 percent of the Rs. 200 crore "venture fund" will be allocated to startups in manufacturing or service sectors linked to drones.
- Special provisions have been made in the policy to promote the establishment of industries related to drones, on the other hand, special attention has also been paid to create skilled human resources in drone technology. Under this, a 50 percent capital subsidy will be given for running a drone school, remote pilot training organization, and drone course, which will be available on a maximum investment of one crore.
- A pivotal aspect for any industry is access to land. The policy encompasses measures to facilitate land availability. The Information Technology Development Agency (ITDA) will have to provide space to the industries related to drone manufacturing and drone service at 50 percent less than the circle rate. Industries in this sector will also benefit from SGST reimbursement.
- The government will reimburse 50 percent of the amount spent on the preparation of the DPR for the project, the maximum limit of which is five lakh rupees. Industries providing a minimum of Rs 100 crore or direct employment to 250 people every year will be provided relief under the MSME policy.

## PROMOTION OF YOUTH ENTREPRENEURSHIP

"Start-ups are playing a crucial role in making India self-reliant." Imbibing this mantra of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami is busy creating a startup ecosystem in Uttarakhand. Its effect is also visible. While there were only 100 startups in the state at the end of 2018, by the end of 2021, this figure had risen to 500. From the growing number of startups to the growing number of incubators, mentors, investors, partners, and so on, the growing number of all stakeholders demonstrates the positive environment created for startups in Uttarakhand. Startup Policy-2023 paves the way for further accelerating the pace of development of a strong startup ecosystem in the state. Through this policy, encouragement and assistance are being provided to startups, incubators, mentors, educational institutions, and investors. The state government has also launched the Startup Official Portal as a "one-stop interactive platform" for innovators and entrepreneurs. Through this, incubators, mentors, investors, educational institutions, students, and service providers can stay connected with each other and keep themselves updated about the startup ecosystem.

## KEY POINTS OF STARTUP POLICY

- As part of the new policy of establishing 1000 startups in five years, the goal is to establish at least one incubator in each district.
- Registered Startup will be given a monthly allowance of Rs 15000 per month for one year. Startups based on SC/ST/Divyang/Transgender or grassroots innovations will get a monthly allowance of Rs 20,000.
- Registered startups will get one-time seed funding up to Rs 10 lakh. Startups based on SC/ST/Divyang/Transgender or grassroots innovations will get seed funding of up to Rs 12.5 lakh.
- Assistance up to Rs 1 lakh per patent for national patent and reimbursement up to Rs 5 lakh for international patent.
- Assistance up to Rs 10, 000 will be given on applications for trademarks and industrial designs.
- Capital subsidy of up to Rs 1 crore will be given for setting up a new incubation center and up to Rs 50 lakh for the expansion of existing incubation centres.